

SFTPAssistant User Guide

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1) Introduction

SFTPAssistant is a Windows tool for automating file transfers using SFTP and Amazon S3. You can create any number of upload/download tasks. Each task is identified by a unique Process Unique Key, allowing you to run tasks manually, on a schedule (Windows Task Scheduler), from SSIS packages, or from scripts.

2) Installation

Install SFTPAssistant using the provided installer (MSI).

After installation, you must validate your license:

```
SFTPAssistant.exe --validate YOUR-LICENSE-KEY
```

This creates a license file under ProgramData and activates the application.

After installation, launch SFTPAssistant from the Start Menu.

3) Creating a new transfer task

Open SFTPAssistant and create a new task. You will configure connection/authentication, file paths, and logging. Save the task to make it available for scheduled or command-line execution.

4) Task configuration fields

4.1 Required fields (all protocols)

- Process Unique Key: Unique identifier used to run the task from the command line.
- Process Name: Friendly name for display (e.g., "Daily Sales Upload").
- Protocol: Choose SFTP or S3.
- Operation: Upload or Download.
- Local directory: Folder to upload from or download to.
- Local file name: File name or pattern (wildcards supported if your configuration allows).
- Remote directory: Remote path (SFTP folder or S3 prefix/folder).
- Remote file name: Remote file name or pattern (if applicable).
- Log file path: Where detailed logs are written.

4.2 Protocol-specific field mapping

When you choose the protocol, the meaning of some fields changes:

- SFTP: Username = Username, Password = Password, Host Key = Host Key (server fingerprint / key).
- S3: Username field becomes Access Key, Password field becomes Secret Key, Host Key field becomes Bucket Name.

4.3 Authentication options

SFTPAssistant supports multiple authentication modes depending on protocol and settings:

- SFTP (username/password): Enter Username and Password. Password is saved encrypted.
- SFTP (PPK key file): Enable “Use Key File (.PPK)” and provide the key file path/content as required.
- S3: Provide Access Key and Secret Key, and the Bucket Name.

4.4 Other options

- Port: Default 22 for SFTP (not used for S3 unless your environment requires it).
- Remote Delete Required: If enabled, deletes remote file after successful download (use carefully).
- Test Connection: Validates connectivity and credentials; use before scheduling.

5) Saving, editing, and deleting tasks

- Save: Stores the current task configuration.
- Delete: Removes the selected task.
- Test Connection: Verifies connectivity and credentials.

6) Running tasks from the command line (headless)

To run a task, call the executable and pass the Process Unique Key as the first argument:

Example:

```
"C:\Program Files\SFTPAssistant\SFTPAssistant.exe" "Your_Process_Unique_Key"
```

This mode is designed for Windows Task Scheduler and SSIS execution without showing the UI.

7) Scheduling with Windows Task Scheduler

- Create a new task in Task Scheduler.
- Action: Start a program.
- Program/script: Path to SFTPAssistant.exe.

- Add arguments: The Process Unique Key (in quotes if it contains spaces).
- Set “Run whether user is logged on or not” for server scenarios.

8) Using SSIS (Execute Process Task)

- Drag an “Execute Process Task” onto the SSIS Control Flow.
- Executable: Full path to SFTPAssistant.exe.
- Arguments: The Process Unique Key (quoted).
- WorkingDirectory: Optional, set to the folder containing the executable.

9) Troubleshooting

If a transfer fails, start with the log file path configured in the task. Common issues include:

- Incorrect credentials (SFTP password / S3 access key + secret key).
- Host/port/firewall issues (SFTP).
- Incorrect bucket name or permissions (S3).
- Local path missing or file pattern doesn’t match any files.
- Remote path permissions or missing directories.

10) Logging

Logs are critical for troubleshooting.

Location:

C:\ProgramData\SFTPAssistant\SFTPAssistant\Logs

11) Support

For help, contact: sftpassistant@gmail.com